



Confirmed and Decided Log 2



This is the decision record for our canon-grounding sessions on *World Without God*. Every entry below spells out the **question**, the **actual options** we weighed (A / B / C / Layered), the **verdict you chose** (verbatim), and the **confirmed canon** that resulted. Nothing here is shorthand — if you picked "A+B," you'll see exactly what A and B were.

How to read each entry

- **The why** — the canon question we were grounding.
 - **Options weighed** — the candidate motives I laid out, lettered A/B/C, plus the "Layered" blend option.
 - **Your verdict** — exactly what you chose (quoted).
 - **Confirmed canon** — the locked motive that goes into the bible.
-

Part A — God-tier divine keystones

The four cosmological load-bearing whys. These set how the gods behave and why the whole tragedy is possible.

1. Why does Razar break divine restraint to back Solis?

Options weighed

- **A — The Founding Debt comes due:** Razar founded the Patton line on a prophecy; backing Solis is the prophecy finally paying off. The root cause.
- **B — The Worship Investment:** an empire of Patton worshippers is Razar's return on investment; he protects the asset.

- **C — The Crown Prince's pet war:** a status/family split among the gods, Solis as Razar's favored cause.

Your verdict: *"A + B/C layered (founding root, others as secondary motives)."*

Confirmed canon: The founding debt (A) is the primary engine — Razar is collecting on the prophecy he staked the dynasty on. The worship return (B) and the divine-family politics (C) are real but secondary reinforcing layers.

2. Why does "The Great Usurper" stick to Solis alongside "revered founder"?

Options weighed

- **A — He usurped a continent:** the sheer scale of what he took earns the title; usurpation that big becomes legend.
- **B — The Twins' slur that outlived them:** Orcus and Iris's propaganda brand for him survived their fall.
- **C — He usurped the gods' prerogative:** a theological reading — he took what belonged to the divine.

Your verdict: *"Other: A+B."*

Confirmed canon: The name sticks because of scale (A) **and** because the Twins' slur outlived them (B). We **dropped C** — the theological "usurped the gods" reading is not the canon reason.

3. Why does Nellebrie arm Harnua against Razar's chosen?

Options weighed

- **A — Cosmic balance:** the pantheon correcting Razar's overreach, impersonal.
- **B — The unloved daughter strikes the golden father through her saint:** Nellebrie's personal wound against Razar, aimed through Harnua.
- **C — Deniable proxy war:** the pantheon checks Razar quietly, plausible deniability.

Your verdict: *"B — The unloved daughter strikes the golden father through her saint."*

Confirmed canon: It's personal. Nellebrie arms Harnua to wound Razar — the slighted daughter striking the favored father through his chosen line.

4. Why does Solis turn from avenger into tyrant?

Options weighed

- **A — The wound that can never close:** grief/trauma he can never resolve, so he never stops.
- **B — The Valea threshold:** he crosses a moral line once, it works, and that opens the door.
- **C — He becomes the usurper he hated:** power itself demands it; he turns into the thing he set out to destroy.

Your verdict: *"C — He becomes the usurper he hated (power demands it)."*

Confirmed canon: Solis becomes the very usurper he rose to overthrow. Power's own logic transforms the avenger into the tyrant.

Part B — Character & house keystones

5. Why does Esterica marry Solis?

Options weighed

- **A — A Fallen house's reclamation:** marrying the rising king to restore her broken house's standing.
- **B — Childhood love, open-eyed:** she loves him and chooses him knowingly.
- **C — The seer who backs the vision:** she sees what he'll become and bets on it.

Your verdict (override): *"She places her bets on Solis because Mihel and Harnua's mom was going to marry her off to the knight/ser she was staying with. She didn't want to become a 2nd wife."*

Confirmed canon: Esterica's driving reason is **escape**. She was about to be married off as a *second wife* to the household knight/ser she was staying with (arranged by Mihel and Harnua's mother). Choosing Solis is the way out of that fate — she bets on him rather than accept a second-wife marriage.

6. Why does Benjamin crown 9-year-old Solis over the trueborn twins?

Options weighed

- **A — Break the Vika stranglehold:** an heir with no powerful maternal house keeps the crown free of Vika control.
- **B — Personal collapse:** an appetite-ruled, wounded king's love for Emillea plus his spite toward his Vika wife.
- **C — He believed Solis was the truer king:** Razar's favor / the "real Patton" reasoning.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A spine (anti-Vika) + B (personal collapse lit the fuse) + tragic irony."*

Confirmed canon: The **spine is A** — breaking the Vika stranglehold. **B (personal collapse) lit the fuse**, and the choice carries tragic irony. (C is not the driver.)

7. Why does harmony-seeking Orcus lead a brutal coup?

Options weighed

- **A — Protection, not ambition:** a passed-over heir either rules or dies; he acts to survive and shield his own.
- **B — Iris is the engine, Orcus is the heart:** he can't refuse the one person he can't lose.
- **C — The rotting-mother wound:** vengeance for Mihai and a refusal to share her fate.

Your verdict: *"Layered — C the shared wound → B Iris drives it → A Orcus acts to protect, not to rule."*

Confirmed canon: Layered in sequence — **C** (the shared mother-wound) is the soil, **B** (Iris drives it) is the engine, and **A** (Orcus acts to protect, not to rule) is how he carries it out.

8. Why does Maen become a paranoid, brutal tyrant?

Options weighed

- **A — The shadow of a god:** he can never be Solis, so he seizes the control that adoration won't give him.
- **B — "Solis's creation":** groomed into a role with no self beneath it; any threat to control feels like annihilation.
- **C — Abandoned twice:** mother dead at 3, father gone — trust is fatal.

Your verdict: *"Other: A + B."*

Confirmed canon: **A + B** — he's the unfillable shadow of a god (A) who was built into a role with no self underneath (B). We **dropped C** (the "abandoned twice" framing is not the driver).

9. Why does Harnua spend her dying breath raising Orcus's moon — bigger and faster than Solis's?

Options weighed

- **A — The last love letter:** her final act of devotion to Orcus.
- **B — The final insult to Solis:** outdoing his moon as a parting blow.
- **C — The saint's apotheosis:** her divine signature on the world.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A engine + B's spite + C's theology (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (love for Orcus) is the engine, sharpened by **B** (spite toward Solis) and elevated by **C** (the saint's theological capstone).

10. Why does Mihel Kulio swear his bloodline will end with him?

Options weighed

- **A — Penance:** the kingmaker sentences himself to erasure for what he set in motion.
- **B — Breaking the curse:** the Fallen end their own rot by ending the line.
- **C — Grief:** nothing and no one left to build a future for.

Your verdict: *"Other: A + C."*

Confirmed canon: **A + C** — penance for his role plus grief with nothing left to build for. We **dropped B** (the "breaking the curse" framing is not canon).

11. Why does Emillea Hige become King Benjamin's concubine?

Options weighed

- **A — Love:** the one real bond in a loveless dynasty.
- **B — The house's one open door:** belated respect/standing for House Hige.
- **C — Agency:** a low-house woman climbs the only ladder available to her.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A starts it, B rides on it, C hardens it (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (love) starts it, **B** (the house's open door) rides on it, **C** (agency) hardens it.

12. Why does Mihai self-poison with Nerai and let her body rot untended?

Options weighed

- **A — The humiliated queen:** her pride annihilated by Emillea's rise.
- **B — The Vika madness:** a sick house claiming its own.
- **C — The trapped hostage:** the only act of will left to a prisoner.

Your verdict: *"Other: A + C."*

Confirmed canon: **A + C** — the humiliated queen (A) exercising the last will left to a trapped hostage (C). We **dropped B** — Mihai is **not** hereditarily/Vika-mad; the "Vika madness" framing is rejected.

13. Why does Orcus reject Harnua's proposal?

Options weighed

- **A — Honesty:** he sees a little sister and won't fake a love he doesn't feel.
- **B — Pride:** a crown earned, not borrowed from a saint's god.
- **C — Protection:** he won't doom her by chaining her to his fall.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A core + B spoken + C buried (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (honesty) is the core, **B** (pride) is what he says aloud, **C** (protection) is the buried truth.

14. Why does Vandrea choose 10,000 years of suffering over a clean kill?

Options weighed

- **A — Proportion ("to suffer as I did"):** a clean kill is too merciful; the punishment must equal her own suffering.
- **B — Displaced guilt:** endless war so she never has to face leaving Enyokia.
- **C — Renedin's bargain:** a god hijacks her grief and stretches it into the long ruin.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A named + B underneath + C the trap (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (proportion) is the reason she'd name, **B** (displaced guilt) runs underneath, **C** (Renedin's bargain) is the trap she's caught in.

15. Why is Iris relentlessly cruel?

Options weighed

- **A — Terror of powerlessness:** never be the rotting, helpless queen.
- **B — Inherited damage:** the Mad House and a childhood of poison.
- **C — Grief weaponized:** avenging her discarded mother.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A engine + B soil + C aim (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (terror of powerlessness) is the engine, **B** (inherited damage) is the soil, **C** (weaponized grief) is the aim.

16. Why does Harnua try to kill her brother Mihel?

Options weighed

- **A — Love over blood:** Orcus above all, even her own brother.
- **B — Betrayal of god and house:** Mihel served the usurper.
- **C — Strategic decapitation:** kill the brain of the enemy to save Orcus.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A engine + B permission + C method (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (love over blood) is the engine, **B** (his betrayal) is the permission, **C** (strategic decapitation) is the method.

17. Why does Solis bury the twins honorably?

Options weighed

- **A — Confession dressed as devotion:** the disaster was his too, and the burial half-admits it.
- **B — Claiming them permanently:** the victor writes the dead into his own story.
- **C — The brother he never got:** love that couldn't be.

Your verdict: *"C — The brother he never got: love that couldn't be."*

Confirmed canon: Solis honors them out of grief for the brother he never got to have — a love that was never allowed to exist.

18. Why does Coyre build a museum for the mother she never knew?

Options weighed

- **A — To meet the mother she was denied:** grief for an absence.
- **B — To author an identity of her own.**
- **C — To found the dynasty's mother-myth.**

Your verdict: *"C — To found the dynasty's mother-myth."*

Confirmed canon: The museum is dynastic myth-making — Coyre founds the official mother-myth of the line.

19. Why does Natav Yailk betray Vikitsv (and die for it anyway)?

Options weighed

- **A — The coward's bargain:** he sold everything to save his own life.
- **B — The man promised everything:** ambition that wouldn't die even as the kingdom fell.
- **C — The believer who stopped believing:** a nationalist's apostasy.

Your verdict: *"Other: A + B."*

Confirmed canon: **A + B** — a coward's bargain to save his skin (A) fused with ambition that outlived the kingdom (B). We **dropped C** (the apostasy/lost-faith framing is not canon).

20. Why does Merigen lead the witch's coup against the Pattons?

Options weighed

- **A — Blood vengeance:** the burned house (Orana) comes home for revenge.
- **B — The persecuted's uprising:** the hunted seize the throne.
- **C — The man who became what he hated:** the persecutor's mirror.

Your verdict: *"B — The persecuted's uprising: the hunted seize the throne."*

Confirmed canon: It's a liberation, framed as the persecuted rising up — the hunted (witches) seizing the throne. (Not primarily personal blood-vengeance.)

21. Why does Benjamin preach against the love that ruins him?

Options weighed

- **A — The creed he inherited:** Pattons sit above human feeling.
- **B — The warning of an addict:** he knows love's power because it owns him.
- **C — The cope of a loveless man:** dignifying a joyless throne.

Your verdict: *"B — The warning of an addict: he knows love's power because it owns him."*

Confirmed canon: Benjamin preaches against love precisely because it owns him — the addict warning others away from his own ruin.

22. Why does Mihai believe Vika blood built the throne?

Options weighed

- **A — Because it's true:** the crown carries an unpayable debt to House Vika.
- **B — Because it's all she was given:** reduced to nothing but her house's worth.
- **C — Because she needed to feel safe:** clinging to a security that wasn't really there.

Your verdict: *"Layered — A foundation + B all she had + C fatal turn (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Layered — **A** (it really is true) is the foundation, **B** (it's all she was given) is why she clings, **C** (the need for safety) is the fatal turn.

23. Why did Reasaec (Equateiy) and Sevtor (Valea/Orana) back Orcus?

Options weighed

- **A — The banker's bet:** legitimacy is the safe investment.
- **B — The blood tie:** a personal/family stake dressed as a cause.
- **C — The fear of Solis:** back the heir to stop the usurper.

Your verdict: *"Layered — Reasaec=A money, Sevtor=B blood, both on C fear (my rec)."*

Confirmed canon: Split motives on a shared fear. **Reasaec backs Orcus for money (A); Sevtor backs him for blood (B); both are driven underneath by fear**

of Solis (C).

24. Why was Iris betrothed to Cequailian Orana?

Options weighed

- **A — Magic wins wars:** the betrothal buys House Orana's Vikitsv sorcery.
- **B — Iris was expendable:** the spare twin, sold off.
- **C — A marriage of equals in shame:** two second-children of suspect houses matched together.

Your verdict: *"Other: B + Iris's father saw her becoming more like her mother and more Vika-like as she grew, and he didn't like that."*

Confirmed canon: B plus a father-animus override. Iris was the expendable spare (B) — but the real driver is Benjamin: as Iris grew, he saw her becoming more like her mother Mihai, more Vika, and he disliked it. Betrothing her to distant Vikitsv both bought the Orana sorcery (the official excuse) **and** removed the daughter who mirrored the wife he'd discarded (the real want). Iris overheard this — the second of only two times she is shown crying. **Irony:** Benjamin's petty act forged the Orana alliance that later became the Twins' deadliest weapon against Solis.

Part C — Grounded but NOT locked

Iris & Yera — why she enslaves the girl who resembles her

I laid out the options below, but **you skipped the survey, so this is not locked.** Recorded here so we don't lose the groundwork.

- **A — The doll she can control:** a version of herself she finally gets to command.
- **B — Punishing the girl she used to be:** hurting the reflection of her own younger, powerless self.

- **C — The only intimacy she can allow:** ownership as the sole form of closeness she permits herself.
- **Layered:** a blend of the above.

Status: Open. Pick a verdict when you want to lock it.

Part D — Open why-candidates (queued, not yet grounded)

- **Apharia** — why she loves Soli.
 - **Renedin** — why his corruption reads as "love" of Vandrea.
 - **Mokar Hige** — why he steals from a dead man to buy a title.
 - **Crandona** — why she falls for Merigen and then kills him.
-

Part E — Unresolved canon flags (need your ruling)

Contradictions surfaced during grounding that are **not yet decided**:

1. **Esterica/Kulio mothers:** Is Mihel & Harnua's relationship to Esterica full siblings (Count Eserindeo Kulio's first wife) — or does the House Kulio page's "Mihel & Esterica full siblings (mother Mihela)" stand? Conflicting parentage.
2. **Merigen reign-length:** ~15-year gap — coup lands ~0/~1 BR, text says "rules six years," but he's overthrown ~14 AR. Numbers don't reconcile.
3. **Nerai contradiction:** described as a slow elixir in one place vs. a near-instant neurotoxin ("the Joyless Death") in another.
4. **Vandrea chronology:** born ~7,236 BR vs. the "over 10,000 years" of suffering. Timeline mismatch.
5. **Magic Tower lineage:** ~2–3 generations vs. centuries; Sevtor descends from Verna's eldest son Liaerto I; Ulian → Kiear / Liaerto III conflict.